

have AGP 4x slots—provided the voltage of the slot is 0.8 V. AGP 8x cards can work in AGP 4x slots with 1.5 V voltages, but may not function properly. Some cards, though, can tolerate the extra voltage. Remember, these cards cannot work with motherboards that have AGP 1x or 2x slots, which generally have 3.3 V.

Conflicting Codecs

Q I have an Intel 3 GHz processor with 256 MB of RAM running Windows XP SP2. A few days ago, I installed K-Lite Codec Pack from your DVD. I also have Windows Media Player 10. The problem is, whenever I play a movie file in WMP10 or the Media Player Classic software that comes with K-Lite codec pack, it hangs, but the sound continues. After I finish my work, when I try to shut down the PC, a pop-up tells me that WMP10 or MP Classic (whichever I used first) is still running, and if I choose “End now”, the PC hangs with a beep. I have no option but to restart and then shut down again. What should I do?

Mandar

A As you might know, K-Lite Codec Pack is a collection of different codecs and related tools. The problem you described can occur if you installed certain codecs and then installed the K-Lite codecs on top of them, thus improperly overwriting the previous versions of those codecs without properly uninstalling them.

Uninstall K-Lite Codec Pack and also uninstall all other previously installed codecs. Then install the latest version of K-Lite Codec Pack from our CD, or download it from www.free-codecs.com/K_Lite_Codec_Pack_download.htm.

While installing the Pack, click Next a few times and do not change the default settings of the installation. At the end, you will be presented with “Additional Tasks”. If you do not want to make Media Player Classic the default for a number of file types, be sure to uncheck the boxes. Leave the rest of the options untouched and finalise the installation process.

We Aren't There Yet

Q I've heard that Bungie studios will soon release the PC version of *Halo 2*, and I'm worried that my current PC won't run it with all the eye-candy. Can you tell me what configuration will let me run *Halo 2* in all its glory (when the PC version arrives)?

Boney Joseph

A *Halo 2* will require Windows Vista, and will not run on older operating systems. One of the system requirements of *Halo 2* is a graphics card that supports DirectX 10. As you may be aware, DirectX 10 has not yet been released, and graphics cards compliant with this version of DirectX are still a few months away. Also, Vista is slated to be released in early 2007, and will ship with DirectX 10 inbuilt. So there's little you can do but wait and watch!

I'm Left With No Option...

Q I have an Intel 865GBF motherboard, a 2.4 GHz Celeron processor, and 256 MB of RAM.

Recently, I downloaded and installed a BIOS setup from the Intel site for the 865GBF motherboard. And now, when I shut down the system, it shuts down perfectly, and I switch off the main power. However, when I switch on the main power again, the PC starts automatically, without waiting for me to press the power button on the cabinet. What's wrong?

Siril B Barot

A Your PC has been set to go to “power on” state while booting. You can configure this option in the BIOS: go to the power options and look for the option that says “After Power Failure” (or something like that). This option determines the mode of operation of the PC if a power loss occurs. It can be set to:

Stay Off—The PC will remain off once power is restored

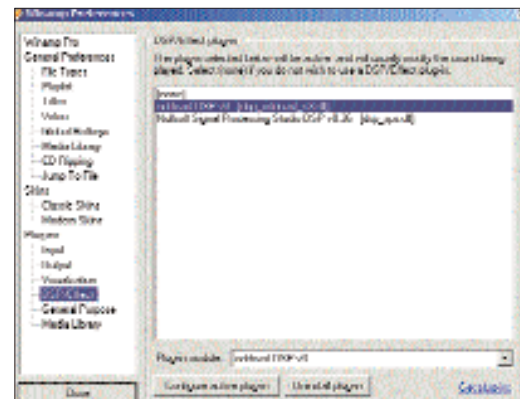
Power On—The PC boots after power is restored

Last State—The PC is restored to the power state it was in when the power loss occurred

You'll want to select the Stay Off option.

It's Whipping The CPU's A**!

Q I have a Pentium 4 2.8 GHz, an original Intel D945GTP motherboard, 512 MB of DDR2 RAM, a 160 GB Seagate SATA, an 80 GB Hitachi ATA, and Windows XP with SP2. This system is too slow and it feels like I'm using a Pentium III, particularly when I play an MP3 using Winamp: the CPU usage shoots up to 100 per cent. What's the problem?



DSP Plugins in Winamp

Aman Jamwal

A First, check if WaveOut is selected as your output API. If it is, select DirectSound; this is the newer and better API—it is faster and consumes less CPU. Second, check to see if you've set Winamp's priority to Realtime—if so, change it to Normal. Third, set Winamp to use no DSP plugins—some of them are CPU hogs.

Access @Home

Q I have a broadband connection from Dish Antenna, with a static IP. I would like to know how I can connect to my server at JNPT, Navi Mumbai, from my residence at Ghatkopar (in